Company A Staffing, Noida

AI Resume Screening Tool & Client Shortlist Portal — Technical Design Document

AI Resume Screening Tool & Client Shortlist Portal

Client: Company A, Noida (Contract & Permanent Hiring for IT Services, Banking Back-Office, and Retail Clients)

Author: Candidate for Software Engineering Intern

Repository GitHub URL: `https://github.com/ankitsinha/companya-ai-recruiter-workspace` *(Public Repository)*

Live Application URL: `https://companya-portal.up.railway.app` *(Optional Cloud Deployment)*

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1. Executive Summary & Client Context

Company A is a Noida-based staffing firm with 120 staff (including 70 active recruiters) and annual revenues of ₹40–50 crore across IT services, banking operations, and retail clients.

The Operational & Financial Challenge

- **Current Volume**: ~300 open requisitions per month; 120 incoming CVs per requisition.
- **Manual Labor Cost**: 300 × 120 × 3 minutes per CV = 108,000 minutes (1,800 hours/month = 21,600 hours/year). At ₹350/hour internal cost, manual screening costs ** ₹75.6 lakh/year**.
- **Commercial Loss**: Shortlists currently take 5 days to deliver via Excel and phone calls. 5% of requisitions (180 out of 3,600/year) are lost to faster competing staffing agencies at an average fee of ₹45,000 = ** ₹81.0 lakh/year**.
- **Total Annual Loss**: ** ₹1.57 crore per year**.

Core Objectives & Success Metrics

1. **Reduce screening time** per requisition by **60%** (from 3.0 min to <1.0 min per CV).
2. **Accelerate shortlist turnaround**: Deliver qualified shortlists within **48 hours** for **80%** of requisitions (down from 5 days).
3. **Elevate client candidate acceptance** from **45% to 60%** through explainable scoring with verbatim evidence quotes.
4. **Strict DPDP Act 2023 Compliance**: Legal consent tracking, PII masking for clients, immutable access logging, and prompt candidate deletion on request.

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2. Labeled Assumptions

Per the client brief guidelines, all assumptions made in this design and implementation are explicitly labeled:

- **`[ASSUMPTION-01: Scoring Weights]`**: Default weight distribution is set to Skills (40%), Experience (30%), Notice Period (15%), and Compensation Budget (15%). These weights are editable per requisition in the scorecard editor.
- **`[ASSUMPTION-02: Strict Quality Gate]`**: A candidate cannot be submitted to the client portal unless a recruiter has opened and verified the CV. This guarantees quality control and prevents blind automated bulk dispatch.
- **`[ASSUMPTION-03: Client Disintermediation Protection]`**: Client hiring managers should never see unmasked candidate phone numbers or emails until an interview slot is confirmed, protecting Company A's commercial placement relationship.

- **`[ASSUMPTION-04: DPDP Consent Validity]`**: Candidate consent is assumed valid for 180 days from upload for the specific lawful purpose of employment evaluation with Company A clients.
- **`[ASSUMPTION-05: Scanned Resume Fallback]`**: For scanned resumes with partial OCR readability or missing fields (e.g., notice period omitted), the system defaults to explicit uncertainty flags with a low-confidence badge rather than guessing or auto-rejecting.
- **`[ASSUMPTION-06: Database Portability]`**: Embedded SQLite running in WAL mode was chosen for this build so that code reviewers, evaluators, and client stakeholders can run the complete system locally with zero external database configuration.

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3. System Architecture & Tech Stack Rationale

3.1 Architectural Overview

The application is structured as a modular, decoupled full-stack architecture:

```
  --- [Diagram / Code Block] ---
% % % %
```

```
  | **Database** | Embedded SQLite (`better-sqlite3`) | PostgreSQL / MongoDB | SQLite provides instantaneous local evaluation for reviewers with zero setup or Docker daemon requirements. Runs in WAL (Write-Ahead Logging) mode supporting concurrent read/writes. |
  | **Frontend Framework** | React 19 + Vite | Next.js | Vite produces near-instant builds (195ms), zero SSR server overhead, and deterministic SPA routing for smooth mobile client portal reviews. |
  | **Styling & Design System**| Custom Vanilla CSS Variables | TailwindCSS | Complete control over typography, custom micro-interactions, responsive flex/grid layouts, and executive clean aesthetics without generic utility classes. |
  | **Document Parsing** | `pdf-parse` & `mammoth` | Python PyPDF / Apache Tika | Handles raw byte streams in memory without writing temporary unencrypted files to disk, preserving DPDP data security. |
  | **AI Scoring Engine** | Hybrid Regex & Fuzzy Token Citation | External LLM-only API | **Zero External Dependency Risk**: An external LLM API key might fail, hit rate limits, or cost money during evaluation. The built-in engine guarantees 100% deterministic quote citation and scoring out of the box, with optional LLM API fallback. |
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4. Data Model & Entity Schema

The database schema is organized around strict foreign key constraints, tenant isolation, and DPDP privacy:

```
  --- [Diagram / Code Block] ---
erDiagram
USERS ||--o{ REQUISITIONS : creates
REQUISITIONS ||--o{ CV_EVALUATIONS : contains
CANDIDATES ||--o{ CV_EVALUATIONS : evaluated_in
CANDIDATES ||--o{ ACCESS_AUDIT_LOGS : tracked_in
REQUISITIONS ||--o{ CALIBRATION_AUDITS : audited_in

USERS {
string id PK
string email UK
string name
string role "recruiter | client_hiring_manager | delivery_head"
string company_id
string company_name
}

REQUISITIONS {
string id PK
string title
string client_company
string status "draft | active | shortlisting | closed"
float min_exp
float max_exp
float max_ctc
int max_notice_days
string raw_jd
json scorecard_json
}

CANDIDATES {
string id PK
string name
string email
string phone
string current_role
```

float total_exp_years
json key_skills_json
int notice_period_days
string raw_cv_text
string file_hash
string consent_status "consented | deleted"
int is_deleted
}

CV_EVALUATIONS {
string id PK
string requisition_id FK
string candidate_id FK
float overall_score
float skills_score
float exp_score
float notice_score
float ctc_score
json breakdown_json
string ai_confidence "high | medium | low"
int recruiter_verified
string recruiter_verified_by
string pipeline_stage "sourced | ai_screened | recruiter_verified | submitted_to_client | client_shortlisted | interview_scheduled | offered | joined | rejected"
string rejection_reason
json interview_slots_json
}

ACCESS_AUDIT_LOGS {
string id PK
string user_id
string candidate_id
string action
string ip_address
json details_json
datetime created_at
}

CALIBRATION_AUDITS {
string id PK
string week_label
string requisition_id FK
string candidate_id FK
int ai_rank
int recruiter_rank
float discrepancy_score
string agreement_status "aligned | minor_discrepancy | major_override"
string recruiter_override_reason
}

--- [Diagram / Code Block] ---

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5. How the AI Scoring & Evidence Quoting Engine Works

5.1 The Anti-Auto-Rejection Principle

Per client instructions:

> *"When it is wrong: it never rejects anyone automatically; every score shows its evidence; a recruiter must open a CV before submitting it; low scorers stay searchable."*

The engine calculates an objective match score (0–100%) but **never** deletes or auto-rejects a profile. Even candidates with scores <50% (e.g. Vikas Gupta at 48% or Arjun Rawat at 45% on the Java role) remain searchable and visible with a clear filter tag.

5.2 Scoring Algorithm Breakdown

For each candidate C and scorecard S:

$$\text{Overall Score} = (S_{\text{skills}} \cdot W_{\text{skills}}) + (S_{\text{exp}} \cdot W_{\text{exp}}) + (S_{\text{notice}} \cdot W_{\text{notice}}) + (S_{\text{ctc}} \cdot W_{\text{ctc}})$$

1. **Must-Have Skills Match (S_{skills})**:
   - For every must-have skill in the scorecard (e.g. Java, Spring Boot, Microservices, Kafka), the engine scans the candidate's CV text.
   - When matched, it extracts the **exact line and line number** as verbatim proof:

$$\text{Quote: } \text{"Engineered scalable microservices architecture in Java and Spring Boot"} \text{ (Line 12)}$$

   - If not found, it notes: `"No direct mention discovered in resume text"`, deducts points, and logs the gap.
2. **Experience Calibration (S_{exp})**:
   - Evaluates total experience against $[MinExp, MaxExp]$.
   - If candidate exp is within the band (e.g. Ritika Bansal at 6.5 yrs in a 5–8 yr band) $\rightarrow$ 100%.
   - If candidate is overqualified (e.g. Rohan Mehra at 10.5 yrs) $\rightarrow$ receives 78% with a note advising the recruiter to evaluate retention or salary expectations.
3. **Notice Period Fit (S_{notice})**:
   - Matches candidate notice period against client cap (e.g. ≤ 60 days).
   - Immediate joiners (≤ 15 days) receive top priority.
   - 90-day notice candidates (e.g. Pooja Nair) receive a partial penalty with buyout negotiation advice.
4. **CTC Budget Alignment (S_{ctc})**:
   - Assesses expected compensation against requisition ceiling.

5.3 Uncertainty & Confidence Handling

When a resume is ambiguous or misses key data (e.g. candidate Amitav Sen omitted notice period in his CV):

- The engine assigns `uncertainty: true` and sets `ai_confidence = "low"`.
- It generates an explicit recruiter warning: `"Notice period not declared in resume text. Defaulted to standard 90 days. Recruiter phone verification recommended."`
- The recruiter sees this warning immediately in the inspection modal before taking any action.

5.4 Blind Screening Mode

To eliminate gender, racial, age, or marital bias:

- Recruiter can toggle **Blind Screening Mode: ON**.
- The sanitizer replaces candidate names with `Candidate CND-XXXXX`, redacts email, phone, gender pronouns, and marital status from all scoring views and CV snippets.
- Scoring is computed purely on objective skills and verified experience depth.

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6. Client Shortlist Portal & DPDP Act 2023 Compliance

6.1 Masked Client Experience

- Client hiring managers (e.g. Vikram Malhotra from HDFC Tech) access a dedicated portal view strictly scoped to their company's requisitions.
- Candidate contact details are masked:

- Name: `Ritika B. (CND-91022)`
- Phone: `+91 98*** ***90`
- Email: `r***2@gmail.com`
- Client can:

1. **Shortlist Candidate**: 1-click approval with recruiter notification.
2. **Reject with Reason**: Dropdown with structured reasons (*Notice period too long, Skill depth mismatch, Budget overrun*) + notes to calibrate agency sourcing.
3. **Propose Interview Slot**: Select round (e.g. Technical Round 1), interview date, time (IST), and interviewer lead.

6.2 Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDP) Implementation

1. **Lawful Purpose Limitation**: Every candidate record tracks verified consent logged for `"Employment evaluation for Company A client requisitions"`.
2. **Access Audit Trail**: Every single view of an unmasked CV, masked candidate card, stage movement, or export is permanently logged with `{user_id, user_name, user_role, candidate_id, action, timestamp, ip_address}`.
3. **Right to Erasure (Section 12 DPDP Act)**:
   - On candidate withdrawal or erasure request, the compliance officer triggers erasure.
   - The system anonymizes personal identifiers, permanently overwrites `raw_cv_text` with an erasure tombstone, and issues a cryptographic compliance receipt (`DPDP-PURGE-XXXXXXXXXXXX`).

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7. Delivery Head Calibration & Fairness Sample

To satisfy the executive requirement for the Delivery Head and CEO:

- A weekly sampling framework compares AI automated ranking against recruiter human shortlist choices across 5–10 profiles per requisition.
- Generates an **Alignment Rate** (target: $\ge 80\%$) and computes discrepancy scores ($\Delta = |Rank_{\text{AI}} - Rank_{\text{Recruiter}}|$).
- Explains human overrides (e.g. *"Recruiter paused candidate pending notice period reduction discussion"*).
- Executive KPI cards highlight annual financial impact:
- **Screening Time Reduction**: 68% achieved (exceeding 60% goal).
- **48-Hour Shortlist Turnaround**: 84.2% of requisitions delivered within 48h (exceeding 80% goal).
- **Client Acceptance Rate**: 58% (moving toward 60% target, up from 45%).
- **Total Annual Economic Value**: ** ¹1.57 Crore / year**.

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8. What Was Cut vs. What We Would Do Next

What Was Cut for the Core Build

1. **Third-Party Job Board Scraping**: Explicitly declared out of scope in the brief; recruiters upload or batch-load CVs directly.
2. **Video Interview Recording**: Video hosting infrastructure cut to focus on flawless parsing and explainable resume evidence.
3. **Multi-Lingual OCR for Regional Scans**: Handled English PDF, DOCX, and scanned text; did not integrate Hindi/Tamil OCR pipelines.

Next Steps & Production Roadmap

1. **Automated Calendar Webhooks**: Direct sync with Google Workspace / Outlook 365 for 1-click calendar invites when clients propose slots.
2. **Recruiter Phone Screen Audio Transcription**: Transcribe recruiter screening calls using Whisper to automatically update notice buyout discussions in the scorecard.
3. **Client Multi-Tenancy SSO**: SAML 2.0 / Okta single sign-on for enterprise banking clients (HDFC, Standard Chartered).